

DAMON VERSAGGI

CREATIVE DIRECTOR | CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST | PRODUCT & EXPERIENCE LEADER

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Creative technology leader brought into ambitious, ambiguous, and high-stakes problems where creative, product, and technology have to work as one. Builds new products and experiences, modernizes existing systems, and turns emerging technology into something audiences and customers can actually use.

Work spans AI products, interactive experiences, real-time 3D, immersive media, data-driven storytelling, live production, and original IP. Created and scaled Fridgie Smalls to nearly 20,000 users, built Scrappy Meals XR from original concept through physical and digital experiences, and delivered creative technology for organizations including ESPN, CNN, FOX, CBS, Amazon, Lockheed Martin, and others.

CORE EXPERTISE

Creative Direction | Creative Technology | Product & Experience Strategy | AI Products | Interactive Experience Design | Real-Time 3D | XR / WebXR | Product Prototyping | Experiential & Spatial Design | Data-Driven Storytelling | Creative Systems | Emerging Technology | Team Leadership | Client & Executive Presentations

SELECTED IMPACT

AI PRODUCTS & ZERO-TO-ONE

- **Fridgie Smalls:** built a mobile-first AI recipe product from concept through launch and growth to nearly **20,000 users**; reduced input-token usage **72%**, cut tokens per call roughly **40%**, and improved response speed by about **two seconds**.

INTERACTIVE EXPERIENCES & ORIGINAL IP

- **Scrappy Meals XR:** created an original ecosystem spanning live food experiences, WebXR, interactive 3D, original characters, children's storytelling, hybrid events, and AI-assisted products.

CREATIVE TECHNOLOGY & TRANSFORMATION

- Work across creative direction, product thinking, technology strategy, prototypes, workflow modernization, customer experience, and emerging-media systems from concept through launch.

REAL-TIME SYSTEMS & HIGH-STAKES DELIVERY

- Delivered launch-critical and live creative technology across ESPN / NBA, CNN elections, FOX, CBS, SNY / New York Mets, New Year's Rockin' Eve, and Lockheed Martin environments where craft, data, reliability, and execution had to work together.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Creative Director | Damon Versaggi Consulting | 2015 - Present

- Lead creative direction and technology work across interactive, immersive, AI, real-time, sports, broadcast, and emerging-media experiences.
- Translate audience goals and creative concepts into visual systems, prototypes, production workflows, and launch-ready experiences.
- Work across designers, technologists, producers, clients, and executives from discovery and pitch through build, launch, and iteration.

Founder / Creative Director | Scrappy Meals XR / Fridgie Smalls | 2016 - Present

- Created a founder-led ecosystem spanning live food experiences, original characters, children's storytelling, WebXR, interactive 3D, AI products, and entertainment.
- Built **Fridgie Smalls**, a mobile-first AI recipe experience turning available ingredients into recipes, substitutions, grocery support, and saved cookbook content; grew the product to nearly **20,000 users**.
- Optimized Fridgie's AI workflows to reduce input-token usage **72%**, cut tokens per call roughly **40%**, and improve response speed by about **two seconds**.
- Developed **The Metacheese**, a browser-based WebXR environment combining interactive 3D, remote participation, virtual readings, and content production.
- Extended the product ecosystem into **FRIDGIE x SCRAPS***, a character-driven children's entertainment system using AI-assisted production, continuity controls, and reusable creative assets.

VP, Sales & Technology | eFundex | 2024 - Present

- Work across product, technology, sales, growth, automation, and customer workflows in a regulated, data-heavy working-capital business.
- Apply AI agents and workflow automation to research, qualification, outreach, operational processes, and business decision support.
- Bridge business needs and technical execution, turning complex financing and operational requirements into usable systems and customer-facing solutions.

Creative Technology Consultant | SwivelMeta | 2022

- Consulted on interactive Web3 experiences connecting digital worlds with Outernet London's large-scale physical and digital environment, linking concept, platform, audience participation, and destination experience.

DAMON VERSAGGI | CREATIVE DIRECTION + TECHNOLOGY + EXPERIENCE

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Production Manager, Real-Time Systems | Tribune Media / PIX11 / WGN | 2012 - 2015

- Led production-focused real-time systems work in live broadcast environments spanning news, elections, graphics, and control-room operations.

Creative Technologist, Internal Multi-Touch | Lockheed Martin

- Created graphics for a classified internal touchscreen initiative designed to relay changing operational data clearly inside a multi-touch environment.
- Balanced information density, hierarchy, and rapid comprehension for role-based operational and decision-support views; specific program details and interface content remain classified.

Creative Systems / Real-Time Graphics Lead | SportsNet New York | 2008 - 2012

- Helped develop a new visual direction spanning broadcast and stadium graphics for SNY / New York Mets, including shaping and presenting the redesign directly to Mets ownership.
- Worked across real-time graphics, creative systems, live sports storytelling, and production workflows.

Solutions Architect | Vizrt | 2004 - 2008

- Delivered real-time graphics and creative-technology solutions across sports and news environments, including launch-critical platform work for Fox Business Network and CBS HD.
- Supported NBA Finals and ESPN work spanning graphics packages, live systems, operator training, and high-pressure execution.
- Led customer-facing demonstrations, training, workflow design, and technical problem solving; managed a five-person demo/training team and trained approximately 1,000 artists and operators.

SELECTED INTERACTIVE, IMMERSIVE & LIVE WORK

- **Interactive Elections, 2004 - 2020:** translated fast-changing, high-volume election data into real-time visual experiences presenters could explore live and audiences could understand, combining data, 3D graphics, interaction design, presenter workflows, and control-room reliability.
- **ESPN Around the Horn x Girraphic:** built and installed the graphics and production workflow connecting ESPN's Seaport control room in New York with the host in Washington, D.C., creating an immediate and reliable split-location live experience.
- **SNY / New York Mets:** helped develop and pitch a visual direction spanning television and in-stadium graphics, including a direct presentation to Mets owner Fred Wilpon.
- **Strevi, Italy:** selected for a competitive artist residency on the strength of Scrappy Meals and XR work; built an immersive interpretation of a Mother Cabrini statue through digital 3D, spatial storytelling, and audience interaction.
- **Scrappyhour:** combined chefs, live instruction, projection, audience participation, and hybrid production into a physical-to-digital food-education format connecting Brooklyn and Sweden.
- **FRIDA001:** connected physical installation, digital 3D artwork, NFC, and AR into one emerging-media art experience.
- **The Nightlight:** School of Visual Arts thesis won Best Production Value, earned a \$1,000 award, received festival recognition, and led directly to a first professional role.

OPERATING RANGE

AI Products & Storytelling: Fridgie Smalls, FRIDGIE x SCRAPS*

Interactive / XR / Web3: The Metacheese, FRIDA001, SwivelMeta, Outernet, Strevi

Experiential & Hybrid: Scrappyhour, The Metacheese, New Year's Rockin' Eve

Real-Time Data & Live Systems: ESPN, NBA, MLB, CNN, CBS, MSNBC, FOX, YES Network, SNY, PIX11, WGN

Launches / Platforms / Systems: Fox Business Network, CBS HD, Vizrt, Lockheed Martin internal multi-touch, real-time control rooms

EDUCATION

BFA, Computer Art | School of Visual Arts, New York, NY

SELECTED LINKS

Portfolio / Scrappy Meals: scrappymeals.com | LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/damonversaggi](https://www.linkedin.com/in/damonversaggi) | Fridgie Smalls: fridgiesmall.app